

Introduction to Applied Linguistics

Department of Foreign Languages and Literature
National Sun Yat-sen University

114-2 (2026 Winter)

- **Meet your instructor**

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Office hours: Weds. 13:00-15:00 and Thurs. 13:00-15:00, or by appointment

- **Course description**

This course introduces the core areas of applied linguistics and shows how linguistic theories are used to address real-world language problems. Topics include language learning, language teaching, bilingualism, language policy, language assessment, psycholinguistics, neurolinguistics, corpus linguistics, and language technology. Students will learn how linguistic research informs educational practice, policy making, and technological development. Note: Some content is subject to change.

- **Learning Objectives**

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. Explain the scope and development of applied linguistics
2. Describe major subfields of applied linguistics
3. Apply linguistic theory to real-world language problems
4. Read and discuss research in applied linguistics critically
5. Connect cognitive and neural evidence to language learning and use

- **Teaching Methods**

1. Lectures and guided discussions
2. Case studies and problem-based learning
3. Group projects and presentations

- **Attendance, Academic Integrity and Responsible AI Use**

Regular attendance and active participation are expected, as much of the learning in this course takes place through in-class activities and discussion. Students are responsible for completing their own work and submitting assignments on time. Being late for **more than ten minutes** to class will constitute an absence. Only

absences such as illness, official commitments, or emergencies will be authorized, and these absences necessitate supporting documentation (e.g., medical certificates, official correspondence) to secure the instructor's approval. Any anticipated absence must be communicated in advance.

Academic honesty is essential to meaningful learning. All submitted work must represent your own thinking and understanding. Plagiarism—including copying from published sources, online materials, classmates, or submitting work generated by others as your own—is not permitted. Any confirmed case of plagiarism or ghostwriting will result in a score of zero for the assignment. Please turn in your assignment on time. Late assignments will NOT be accepted.

The use of AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Grammarly, translation tools) is allowed only as a learning aid, such as for brainstorming ideas, clarifying concepts, or improving language clarity. However, AI tools may not be used to generate full assignments, quizzes, or written responses unless explicitly permitted by the instructor. Any use of AI must be transparent and properly acknowledged when relevant. Students are responsible for ensuring that all submitted work reflects their own comprehension and meets the academic standards of the course.

- **Your perspective matters!**

Please keep in mind that the readings, lectures, and comments from the instructors will reflect a particular point of view. These perspectives may not be the same as yours! If you find that you disagree with the ideas in the readings and lectures or the perspectives of your colleagues in the course, please express yourself!! A significant part of a college education is learning about the complexity of various issues. Therefore, it is important that we listen and respect one another but we do not have to agree. A richer discussion will occur when a variety of perspectives are presented in class.

- **Student Well-being**

Students may experience stressors that can impact both their academic experience and their personal well-being. These may include academic pressure and challenges associated with relationships, physical health, mental health, alcohol or other drugs, identities, finances, etc. If you are experiencing concerns, **seeking help is a best thing to do for yourself and those who care about you**. If the source of your stressors is academic, please contact me so that we can find solutions together. For personal concerns, you can also find the resources on the department website.

- **Accommodations**

If you think you need an accommodation for a disability, please let me know at your earliest convenience. Many aspects of this course, the assignments, the in-class activities, and the way the course is usually taught may be modified to facilitate your participation and progress. As soon as you make me aware of your needs, we can work with the Office of Services for Students with Disabilities (SSD) to help determine appropriate academic accommodations.

- **Required readings**

Weekly assigned readings will be posted on the course website (Canvas). The course material is provided for educational purposes only and is accessible only to students enrolled in this course.

- **Evaluations**

Category	Percentage	Description
Participation and in-class discussion	15%	Students are expected to attend the class in-person and participate the discussion.
Weekly Reading Quizzes	13%	A reading quiz of the assigned reading will be taken at the beginning of the class.
Reading Summary (2)	22%	2 summaries of research articles (details below)
Midterm Exam (Open Notes)	15%	Mid-term exam will be taken in class.
Final Term Paper	15%	2000-2500 words for the group project (details below)
Final Group Project Presentation	20%	Details below.

- **Schedule (subject to change)**

Week	Topic/Focus	Assigned Reading	Assignments/Activities
1	Course Introduction & What Is Applied Linguistics?	Schmitt & Celce-Murcia 2020	Syllabus Review; Overview of applied linguistics Week 1 reading quiz
2	Language and Society: Sociolinguistics	Llamas & Stockwell 2020	Week 2 reading quiz
3	Language and Culture: Pragmatics	Spencer-Oatey & Žegarac 2020	Week 3 reading quiz
4	Language Acquisition I: L1 and L2	Saville-Troike 2005	Week 4 reading quiz
5	Language Acquisition II: Learning Mechanisms	Ellis 2008	Week 5 reading quiz
6	Language Teaching Methods	Celce-Murcia 2014	Week 6 reading quiz; Reading summary 1 DUE
7	Materials and Curriculum Design	Richards 2001	Week 7 reading quiz
8	Midterm Exam (Open Notes)	–	–
9	Language Assessment and Testing	Fulcher & Davidson 2007, Ch. 1	Week 9 reading quiz
10	Bilingualism and Language Policy	Gorter & Cenoz 2017	Week 10 reading quiz
11	Neurolinguistics: Language in the Brain	Vandenberghe et al. 2019	Week 11 reading quiz
12	Psycholinguistics: Language Processing	Mech et al. 2020	Week 12 reading quiz
13	Corpus Linguistics and Applications	Reppen & Simpson-Vlach, 2020	Week 13 reading quiz; Reading summary 2 DUE
14	Technology, AI, and Applied Linguistics	Önem 2025	Week 14 reading quiz
15	Student Project Presentations	–	15-min presentation & 5-min QA
16	Integration and Future Directions	–	Final Paper Due (6/12)

Assigned Reading List

- Celce-Murcia, M. (2014). An overview of language teaching methods and approaches. In M. Celce-Murcia, D. M. Brinton, & M. A. Snow (Eds.), *Teaching English as a second or foreign language* (4th ed., pp. 2–14). National Geographic Learning.
- Ellis, N. C. (2008). Implicit and explicit knowledge about language. In J. Cenoz & N. H. Hornberger (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Language and Education* (2nd ed., Vol. 6, pp. 119–131). Springer.
- Fulcher, G., & Davidson, F. (2007). *Language testing and assessment: An advanced resource book*. Routledge. (Chapter 1)
- Gorter, D., & Cenoz, J. (2017). Language education policy and multilingual assessment. *Language and Education*, 31(3), 231–248.
- Llamas, C., & Stockwell, P. (2020). Sociolinguistics. In N. Schmitt & M. Celce-Murcia (Eds.), *An introduction to applied linguistics* (3rd ed.). Routledge.
- Mech, E. N., Takahesu Tabori, A., Kroll, J. F., & de Bot, K. (2020). Psycholinguistics. In N. Schmitt & M. P. H. Rodgers (Eds.), *An introduction to applied linguistics* (3rd ed., pp. 128–145). Routledge.
- Önem, E. E. (2025). AI in applied linguistics: Implications, limitations, and issues. *Journal of Language Education and Research*, 11(2), 957–969.
- Reppen, R., & Simpson-Vlach, R. (2020). Corpus linguistics. In N. Schmitt & M. Celce-Murcia (Eds.), *An introduction to applied linguistics* (3rd ed.). Routledge.
- Richards, J. C. (2001). *Curriculum development in language teaching*. Cambridge University Press.
- Saville-Troike, M. (2005). *Introducing second language acquisition*. Cambridge University Press.
- Schmitt, N., & Celce-Murcia, M. (2020). An overview of applied linguistics. In N. Schmitt & M. Celce-Murcia (Eds.), *An introduction to applied linguistics* (3rd ed., pp. 1–16). Routledge.
- Spencer-Oatey, H., & Žegarac, V. (2020). Pragmatics. In N. Schmitt & M. Celce-Murcia (Eds.), *An introduction to applied linguistics* (3rd ed.). Routledge.
- Vandenberghe, B., Montero Perez, M., Reynvoet, B., & Desmet, P. (2019). The role of event-related potentials (ERPs) as sensitive measures in L2 vocabulary acquisition research. *Journal of the European Second Language Association*, 3(1), 35–45.

Reading Summary (2 submissions)

- **Task Description**

For each submission, choose ONE research article from the approved list below and write a 300–500 word summary in your own words. Each summary should include:

1. The research focus and question(s)
2. A brief description of the methodology (e.g., participants, data, methods)
3. The main findings or arguments
4. The implications for applied linguistics (e.g., teaching, learning, assessment, or language use)

A full APA-style reference and a working link or DOI must be included.

- **Approved Sample Articles**

Students may choose from the following example articles or use Google Scholar to find other articles. Consult with me if you are not sure whether the article is fine.

1. Godwin-Jones, R. (2022). Partnering with AI: Intelligent writing assistance and instructed language learning. *Language Learning & Technology*, 26(2), 5–24.
2. Hartshorne, J. K., Tenenbaum, J. B., & Pinker, S. (2018). A critical period for second language acquisition: Evidence from 2/3 million English speakers. *Cognition*, 177, 263–277.
3. Rodrigo A. Rodríguez-Fuentes & Aleksandra M. Swatek. (2022). Exploring the effect of corpus-informed and conventional homework materials on fostering EFL students' grammatical construction learning. *System*(104): 102676.

- **AI Use & Academic Integrity**

AI tools may be used only as learning aids (e.g., vocabulary clarification or language editing). AI may not be used to generate the summary itself.

Each submission must include the following statement:

AI Use Declaration: I confirm that this summary was written in my own words. Any AI tools used were limited to language support or idea clarification.

Plagiarism or ghostwriting will result in a score of zero for the assignment.

Final Group Project Presentation

Group members: 3 people as a group, reach me if you have difficulty finding group members.

Presentation format: PowerPoint (or equivalent)

Length: 15 minutes + 5 minutes Q&A

Timing: Week 15 (& Week 16)

- **Evaluation**

Me 80% and audience (Your classmates!) 20%

- **Presentation Options**

Groups may choose ONE of the following:

- **Option A: Research Proposal**

The presentation should include:

1. Research topic and motivation
2. Research question(s)
3. Brief background based on course readings
4. Proposed data and method (descriptive, not technical)
5. Expected outcomes and relevance to applied linguistics

- **Option B: Case Study**

The presentation should include:

1. Description of the case (e.g., classroom, learner experience, language use, technology, media, or policy)
2. Relevant applied linguistics concepts from the course
3. Examples or observations (no formal data collection required)
4. Analysis and interpretation
5. Practical implications or suggestions

All group members are expected to participate in the presentation.

Final Term Paper

Length: 2,000–2,500 words (excluding references)

Language: English

The term paper should be a written expansion of the presentation topic.

Clear organization and explanation are more important than technical detail.

- **Paper Structure (Suggested)**

For Research Proposal	For Case Study
Introduction and motivation	Introduction to the case
Brief literature background	Relevant theoretical concepts
Research questions	Analysis and discussion
Proposed approach	Implications and reflections
Expected contribution	–

A minimum of 6 academic references is required. APA-style citation is expected.

- **Contribution Statement (Required)**

Please include a Contribution Statement at the end of the term paper, clearly listing the contribution of each group member (e.g., literature review, data/examples, analysis, writing, editing, presentation preparation).

Each member is expected to contribute to the project equally.

The grading of the final term paper will also take individual contribution into consideration.

- **Evaluation Criteria**

The project will be evaluated based on:

- Understanding and application of course concepts
- Clarity of ideas and organization
- Depth of analysis and reflection
- Quality of writing and presentation
- Evidence of fair and meaningful collaboration

- **Academic Integrity & AI Use**

AI tools may be used only for language editing or idea clarification. AI may not be used to generate analysis or replace students' own writing. Any use of AI must be responsible and transparent. Plagiarism or ghostwriting will result in a score of zero for the project.